

COMPREHENSIVE HR POLICY MANUAL

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Effective Date: [Date]

Approved By: [Board of Directors / Human Resources Department]

Applicability: All Full-Time, Part-Time, and Contract Employees

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1. NATURE OF EMPLOYMENT & HIRING POLICIES

1.1 Equal Opportunity Statement

[Company Name] is an Equal Opportunity Employer. Hiring, promotions, and compensation decisions are made without regard to race, color, religion, sex, sexual orientation, gender identity, national origin, disability, or veteran status.

1.2 Recruitment & Background Screening

- All prospective employees must pass pre-employment background verification (criminal record check, previous employment verification, and educational background checks).
- Providing false or misleading information during the recruitment process is grounds for immediate rescission of an offer or termination of employment.

1.3 Probationary Period

- All newly hired regular employees will undergo a probationary period of ninety (90) calendar days [or specify 3 to 6 months] from their start date.
- During this period, the employee's performance, conduct, and cultural alignment are evaluated.
- At the end of probation, HR and the direct supervisor will issue a written confirmation, extend the probation (maximum 30 additional days), or end employment with [X days'] notice.

1.4 At-Will Employment Disclaimer (Applicable in US jurisdictions)

Employment with [Company Name] is "at-will." Both the employee and the company have the right to terminate the employment relationship at any time, with or without cause, and with or without advance notice, subject to local labor laws.

2. WORKING HOURS, ATTENDANCE & HYBRID WORK

- Core Hours: Standard business hours are [9:00 AM to 6:00 PM], Monday through Friday, including a mandatory 60-minute meal break.
- Overtime: Non-exempt employees are eligible for overtime pay for hours worked beyond 40 hours per week, which must be pre-approved in writing by their manager.
- Hybrid / Remote Policy: Eligible roles may work remotely up to [e.g., 2 days per week]. Remote employees must be available via communication tools (e.g., Slack/Teams/Email) during core working hours and maintain high-speed, secure internet access.

3. COMPENSATION, INSURANCE & HEALTHCARE

3.1 Payroll & Deductions

- Salaries are paid on the [e.g., 25th / last business day] of each month via direct bank transfer.
- Deductions for mandatory taxes, social security, retirement funds, and elective employee benefit contributions are automatically withheld.

3.2 Medical & Health Insurance

Coverage begins on the first day of the month following [30 days of employment /

the hire date].

- Primary Health Insurance: The company covers [e.g., 80% to 100%] of the employee's premium and [e.g., 50%] of eligible dependent premiums.
- Dental & Vision Coverage: Optional or fully sponsored coverage providing annual checkups, basic care, and orthodontic discounts.
- Group Term Life & Accidental Death & Dismemberment (AD&D): The company provides basic life insurance coverage equivalent to [e.g., 1x or 2x annual base salary] at no cost to the employee.
- Short-Term & Long-Term Disability (STD/LTD): Coverage providing partial salary replacement (typically 60%) in the event of an extended illness or non-occupational injury.

4. LEAVE POLICIES, HOLIDAY CALENDARS & CARRYOVER RULES

4.1 Annual Paid Time Off (PTO)

- Full-time employees accrue [e.g., 1.5 days per month / 18 days annually].
- PTO must be requested through the HR portal at least [2 weeks] in advance for leaves lasting 3 or more consecutive business days.

4.2 Leave Expiry & Carryover Policy

- Use-It-or-Lose-It Clause: Employees are strongly encouraged to take their annual leave within the calendar year (January 1 to December 31).
- Maximum Carryover: A maximum of [e.g., 5 days] of unused PTO may be rolled over into the following calendar year.
- Expiration Date: Any carried-over days must be utilized before [March 31st] of the new year, after which they will expire and be forfeited.
- Encashment: Unused leave [is / is not] eligible for cash encashment at the end of the year, except where mandated by local labor law upon termination.

4.3 Sick & Medical Leave

- Employees are allotted [e.g., 10 days] of paid sick leave annually on January 1st (prorated for new hires).
- For absences exceeding three (3) consecutive business days, a certified doctor's note must be submitted to HR.

- Sick leave cannot be carried over to the following year and has no cash surrender value.

4.4 Public & Floating Holidays

- Standard Holidays: The company observes all statutory public holidays (typically 10–12 days per year, published by HR every December).
- Floating Holidays: Employees receive [2] personal/floating holidays per year to observe religious, cultural, or personal occasions not covered by the standard holiday schedule.

4.5 Parental & Bereavement Leave

- Parental Leave: Primary caregivers receive [e.g., 12 to 16 weeks] of paid leave; secondary caregivers receive [e.g., 4 to 6 weeks] of paid leave.
- Bereavement Leave: Employees may take up to [3 to 5 days] of paid leave in the event of the loss of an immediate family member (parent, spouse, child, sibling).

5. EMPLOYEE BENEFITS & PERKS

5.1 Retirement Plan / 401(k)

- Employees are eligible to participate after [30 days / 90 days] of service.
- The company matches [100% of employee contributions up to 4% of base salary].
- Company matching contributions vest over a [3-year graded / immediate] schedule.

5.2 Professional Development & Tuition Assistance

- Full-time employees who have completed their probationary period may apply for a professional development stipend of up to [\$1,000 to \$2,500] annually for job-related certifications, courses, and conferences.

5.3 Wellness & Employee Assistance Program (EAP)

- EAP: Free, confidential counseling and advisory services available 24/7 for

employees and their immediate families dealing with mental health, financial, or legal challenges.

- Gym / Wellness Subsidy: A reimbursement of up to [\$50] per month toward a gym membership, fitness app, or wellness program.

6. CODE OF CONDUCT & WORKPLACE ETHICS

- Anti-Harassment & Zero Tolerance: Any form of harassment, discrimination, bullying, or microaggressions will result in immediate disciplinary review up to termination.
- Conflict of Interest: Employees must not operate secondary businesses or freelance for clients, vendors, or competitors without prior written authorization from HR and executive management.
- Data Security & Privacy: Employees must use company-approved passwords, multi-factor authentication (MFA), and secure VPNs. Proprietary data must not be stored on personal devices or personal cloud storage.

7. PERFORMANCE MANAGEMENT & PROGRESSIVE DISCIPLINE

Except for instances of gross misconduct, [Company Name] follows a progressive discipline approach:

1. Step 1: Informal Counseling / Verbal Warning: An informal conversation between the manager and the employee to address minor infractions.
2. Step 2: Formal Written Warning: Documented letter issued by HR, outlining the issue, expectations, and a timeline for correction. Placed in the personnel file.
3. Step 3: Performance Improvement Plan (PIP): A 30- to 60-day formal plan with clear metrics. Failure to meet PIP targets results in termination.
4. Step 4: Employment Separation: Termination of employment.

8. SEPARATION & TERMINATION POLICY (HIRE & FIRE)

8.1 Voluntary Resignation

- Non-management employees must provide at least two (2) weeks' written notice.
- Managers, directors, and executives are requested to provide at least four

(4) weeks' written notice.

- Notice must be submitted in writing to the direct manager and HR.

8.2 Involuntary Termination (Without Cause / Redundancy)

- In the event of economic downturns, organizational restructuring, or position elimination, affected employees will receive:
 - Written notification.
 - Severance Pay: Standard severance of [e.g., 1 to 2 weeks' base salary per year of service], contingent upon signing a standard release agreement.
 - Extended health benefit coverage or COBRA notification as required by law.

8.3 Involuntary Termination (For Cause / Gross Misconduct)

Immediate dismissal without notice, severance, or payment in lieu of notice will occur in cases of:

- Theft, fraud, or embezzlement.
- Physical violence, threats, or severe harassment.
- Intentional breach of confidentiality or theft of intellectual property.
- Working under the influence of illegal drugs or alcohol.

8.4 Offboarding & Exit Procedures

- Return of Company Property: On or before the last working day, the employee must return all company-owned assets (laptops, monitors, security badges, corporate credit cards).
- Final Paycheck: Processed on the next regular pay cycle or as mandated by state/regional law, including earned base pay and any accrued, unused PTO where legally required.
- Exit Interview: An optional, confidential interview with HR to discuss the employee's overall experience and reasons for departure.

9. EMPLOYEE ACKNOWLEDGMENT & RECEIPT

(To be signed and returned to HR via portal within 14 days of start date)

I, _____ [Employee Name],
acknowledge that I have received a copy of the [Company Name] HR Policy Manual.

I understand that this document contains important information about the company's guidelines, employee expectations, benefits, insurance policies, and employment terms. I agree to read and adhere to all policies outlined within this handbook.

I understand that the company reserves the right to modify, amend, or revoke any policy at any time with prior notice.

Employee Signature: _____

Printed Name: _____

Date: _____

HR Representative Signature: _____